Indian rivalry" in Myanmar, the idea of a "Sino-Indian Great Game" still marks Indian debate, thinking, and policy on Myanmar.[78] It seems China's continued rise will remain a main driver behind India's Myanmar policy, as Myanmar will remain geostrategically relevant to India. In addition, Modi's upgrading of the "Look East policy" to an "Act East policy" points to a willingness to prioritise India's neighbourhood further.

India under Modi certainly wishes to be the preferred partner of its neigh-bouring countries in South Asia. The BRI, however, will likely increasingly make China a competitor to Indian interests. While Modi's initial response to the BRI was muted,[79] New Delhi has actively argued that India must seek cooperation with its neighbours, particularly within connectivity.[80] Indian scepticism of the BRI remains staunch and has kept Indian politicians away from both the First (May 2017) and Second (April 2019) Belt and Road Forum (BRF) for International Cooperation.[81] The Modi government has explained its concern over the CPEC, stating that it "violates India's sovereignty and territorial integrity. No country can accept a project that ignores its core concerns on sovereignty and territorial integrity."[82]

Pakistan and Nepal were the only two South Asian nations represented at the recent Second BRF, but the fact remains that BRI projects have also been accepted by Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, the Maldives, Myanmar, and Afghanistan. In addition to the disagreements over the border and the contested areas, China and India have also disagreed over the status of Nepal, Bhutan, and Sikkim. In late 2015, China signed a series of bilateral treaties with Nepal after India had voiced concerns over Nepal's 2015 constitution and following the blocking of Indian goods and fuel to Nepal. A 2016 Transport and Transit Agreement between Nepal and China was finalised in late 2018 and signed during the Second BRF, further raising Indian concerns about Nepalese